TOOL

Writing checklist

Go through this before you hand in. The high-priority items cost the most marks.

GENERAL: ALL TEXT TYPES

- [ ] I read the task twice and underlined the text type, the audience, the word count and all three content points. **(high priority)**
- [ ] I covered content point 1 in a fully developed paragraph. **(high priority)**
- [ ] I covered content point 2 in a fully developed paragraph. **(high priority)**
- [ ] I covered content point 3 in a fully developed paragraph. **(high priority)**
- [ ] My text has exactly five paragraphs: introduction, one for each content point, conclusion. **(high priority)**
- [ ] My word count is within ±10% of the number in the task (for a 250-word task, 225–275).
- [ ] I started every body paragraph with a clear topic sentence.
- [ ] I used at least five different linking words (Furthermore, However, Consequently ...).
- [ ] I did not copy sentences from the task or the material. I put figures and ideas in my own words. **(high priority)**
- [ ] I used at least two complex structures (passive voice, conditional, relative clause).
- [ ] I proofread for my personal weak spots (articles, third-person -s, tenses).

ESSAY: SPECIFIC (AHS ONLY)

- [ ] I wrote a factual title that names the topic (a statement, not a question).
- [ ] I stated my opinion clearly in the introduction.
- [ ] I kept a formal register throughout: no contractions, no slang.
- [ ] I argued mainly with general and hypothetical examples (a short personal example at most).
- [ ] My conclusion restates my opinion in different words (not copied from the introduction).

ARTICLE: SPECIFIC

- [ ] My title catches attention (a question, alliteration or a bold statement).
- [ ] I wrote for a clear target audience and matched the register.
- [ ] I used at least one rhetorical question to involve the reader.
- [ ] I included at least one personal example or experience.
- [ ] My conclusion leaves the reader thinking or asks them to act.

REPORT: SPECIFIC

- [ ] My header includes Date, From and Subject. **(high priority)**
- [ ] I gave every section a meaningful heading. **(high priority)**
- [ ] I used neutral language in the body: no "I think", no emotional words.
- [ ] I included specific figures when presenting the findings.
- [ ] My conclusion includes clear, formal recommendations.
- [ ] I did not include a greeting (Dear Sir or Madam); reports do not have one.

BLOG: SPECIFIC

- [ ] I put a username and the date/time at the top.
- [ ] Blog post: I wrote an attention-grabbing title. Blog comment: I left out the title.
- [ ] I wrote in a personal, informal voice.
- [ ] Blog comment only: my first sentence refers to the original post, ideally by name. **(high priority)**
- [ ] Blog post: my conclusion invites readers to comment.

E-MAIL: SPECIFIC

- [ ] My header includes To, From, Date and a Subject line. **(high priority)**
- [ ] I used a greeting that fits the recipient (formal: Dear Sir or Madam, / Dear Mr/Ms [Name],).
- [ ] My first sentence says clearly why I am writing.
- [ ] I used the correct sign-off: Yours faithfully (name unknown) / Yours sincerely (name known).
- [ ] My register matches the recipient: no contractions in a formal e-mail ("do not" instead of "don't"), a relaxed tone only if the task is informal.
- [ ] I followed the conventions of the sub-type (complaint / application / letter to the editor / enquiry).

LEAFLET: SPECIFIC (BHS ONLY)

- [ ] I gave the leaflet a clear title and broke the text into short sections with subheadings. **(high priority)**
- [ ] I wrote for a specific audience and matched the register (easy to read, no slang, not stiff).
- [ ] I told readers what they gain and spoke to them directly with "you".
- [ ] I kept the sections short and easy to scan, with no long blocks of text.
- [ ] I ended with a clear call to action (come, sign up, get in touch). **(high priority)**
- [ ] I included the practical details the reader needs to act: date/time and place for an event, or how to sign up / where to buy / a website for a scheme or product.